

BUSS UP SHUT - FLATBREAD

Trinidad

INGREDIENTS

330g flour
3/4 tsp baking powder 1/2 tsp salt
3/4 tsp sugar
180-220ml water (don't add all at once, it will depend on the flour used how much you need exactly)
Ghee (or clarified butter) - slightly melted or softened to make it easy to spread out over the dough surface
Flour for rolling

METHOD

Step 1

Mix the flour, baking powder, salt, and sugar. Add the water gradually to make a dough. The dough will be slightly sticky and very flexible. However, after some gentle kneading it should come clean off your hands. Knead the dough together until it comes together in a nice ball, don't knead it any further.

Step 2

Leave to rest for at least 15 minutes to relax the gluten.

Split the dough into 4 separate balls to make 4 paratha roti with a diameter of about 22cm each. Adjust the number of portions based on your pan size.

Step 3:

Roll out the dough in flat circles. It will be slightly sticky, so use ample flour.

Step 4:

Cover the dough with a thin layer of ghee, make sure to spread it out evenly.

Step 5:

Lightly dust the top with a little flour (this makes it easier to roll).

Step 6:

Now make a cut from the center of the dough circle to the outside and start rolling the dough from that cut in a circle to the other side of the cut (see image in the post). You will end up with a cone. Ensure that the bottom doesn't have fat sticking out, stretch the outer layer of dough to cover the inner layers. Now push the pointy top of the cone inside to tighten and dust with some flour. Pushing it into the middle helps create all those dough layers!

Step 7:

Leave to rest for another 15-30 minutes, even better would be at least an hour. A longer resting period makes it easier to roll out the dough.

Step 8:

Heat a flat baking surface on a medium heat (e.g. using a tawa).

Roll out the balls of dough and bake on the flat surface on a medium heat. Coat the top with a thin layer of ghee (or clarified butter). When the top starts getting drier, turn the dough around. Again, cover the topside with a thin layer of ghee.

Step 9:

Towards the end, when the dough starts to be cooked through, take two spatulas and loosen the paratha by inwards pushing on the sides of the paratha. Due to all the rolling you should have made layers of dough with fat in between. By 'beating' the paratha and folding it together you help all the layers get loose and flaky.

You want the different layers to separate, so crinkle and beat until you see them coming apart. The paratha is ready once it has turned slightly brown and a loosened up structure.